

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

FRIDAY, APRIL 18, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 90

WSJ.com

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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Alphabet's Google created** a monopoly that allowed it to control parts of the on-line-advertising industry, a judge ruled, a decision that could upend one of the company's core businesses. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump lashed out** at Powell, hinting at potentially dismissing the central bank chair a day after Powell warned that the Fed could face a difficult trade-off as tariffs raise prices and weaken the economy. **A1**
- ◆ **The ECB cut interest** rates to offset the economic blow of tariffs, with the institution's leader saying the outlook was clouded by "exceptional uncertainty." **A5**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks ended** mixed on the last day of trading this week, with the S&P 500 gaining 0.1% and the Dow and Nasdaq falling 1.3% and 0.1%, respectively. Markets are closed on Friday. **B1**
- ◆ **UnitedHealth's shares** fell more than 22% after earnings fell short of analyst expectations and the insurer cut its guidance for the full year, citing problems in its Medicare business. **B1**
- ◆ **Higher-than-expected** subscription and ad revenue helped Netflix beat its forecast for core metrics, including revenue and its operating margin in the first quarter. **B1**
- ◆ **Hedge-fund manager** Bill Ackman disclosed a nearly 20% stake in rental-car company Hertz as he laid out his bullish reasoning behind the bet. **B1**
- ◆ **Global Payments is** acquiring Worldpay for \$24.25 billion in three-way deal with Fidelity National Information Services and private-equity firm GTCR. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Many U.S. trade** partners have vowed to buy more American goods in an effort to persuade Washington to refrain from reimposing stiff duties on their exports, but other countries are standing aside. **A1, A4-6**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** agreed to hear oral arguments over the legality of Trump's executive order ending birthright citizenship for the children of undocumented immigrants and foreign residents. **A3**
- ◆ **Sen. Chris Van Hollen** said he has met with Kilmar Abrego Garcia, the man who was mistakenly deported to a prison in El Salvador. **A2**
- ◆ **An appeals court** rebuked the Trump administration for its renewed challenge to an order that it seek the return of Kilmar Abrego Garcia. **A2**
- ◆ **A suspected gunman** arrested after a mass shooting at Florida State University that left two people dead is the son of a local sheriff's deputy, authorities said. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** threatened to stop international students from attending Harvard as part of a growing pressure campaign. **A3**
- ◆ **U.S.-Russia talks** are focusing on five regions of Ukraine that Moscow claims as its own but that Kyiv isn't prepared to give up. **A16**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is proceeding to drastically curtail the work of the government's consumer-finance watchdog after a legal victory. **A2**
- ◆ **The Energy Department** is preparing cuts that could halt nearly \$10 billion in funding for clean-energy projects. **A2**

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Judge Says Google Operates Ad Monopoly

Tech giant faces legal threats tied to how it wields power in ad-tech business

By JAN WOLFE
AND PATIENCE HAGGIN

Alphabet's Google created a monopoly that allowed it to control parts of the online-advertising industry, a federal

judge ruled, a decision that could upend one of the technology giant's core businesses.

The ruling marked the second time in eight months that a U.S. judge labeled Google an illegal monopolist—and it could lead the Justice Department to seek a forced sale of some of the company's advertising products.

Alphabet's shares fell 1.4% on Thursday. The company plans to appeal the ruling.

U.S. District Judge Leonie Brinkema said Google's monopoly in ad exchanges and server markets violated the Sherman Antitrust Act, harming advertisers and consumers.

Brinkema said in her written ruling that the company also engaged in unlawful "tying"—conditioning access to one product on paying for the other.

"In addition to depriving rivals of the ability to compete," the judge wrote, "this exclu-

sionary conduct substantially harmed Google's publisher customers, the competitive process, and, ultimately, consumers of information on the open web."

The Justice Department didn't win on all of its legal claims. The judge rejected the government's position that Google unlawfully monopolized a third market that helps advertisers buy display ads across the open web.

Lee-Anne Mulholland, a Google vice president, said the company would appeal the parts of the decision that it lost. "We disagree with the court's decision regarding our publisher tools. Publishers have many options and they choose Google because our ad tech tools are simple, affordable and effective," Mulholland said.

The Justice Department has suggested that Google should

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Italian Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni met with President Trump on Thursday in the Oval Office, where she invited him to visit her nation and meet European officials for trade talks. **A5**

Trump Escalates Feud With Fed, Eyes Firing Chair

By NICK TIMIRAO

President Trump lashed out at Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell, hinting at potentially dismissing the central bank leader, one day after Powell warned that the Fed could face a difficult trade-off as tariffs raise prices and weaken the economy.

"Powell's termination cannot come fast enough!" Trump wrote in a social-media post on Thursday morning.

Later Thursday, in the Oval

Office, Trump said he had the power to dismiss Powell as Fed chair—a position that is at odds with Powell's view of the law. "If I want him out, he'll be out of there real fast, believe me," Trump said. On Wednesday, Powell repeated his longstanding view that the law didn't permit his removal.

During Trump's first term, Powell told the president's advisers that he would challenge his removal in court.

Trump is upset that the Fed

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President Has Muddled Powell Fate for Months

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ
AND NICK TIMIRAO

WASHINGTON—President Trump has for months privately discussed firing Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell, according to people familiar with the matter, but he hasn't made a final decision about whether to try to oust him before his term ends next year.

In meetings at the president's private Florida club, Mar-a-Lago, Trump has spoken with Kevin Warsh, a for-

mer Fed governor, about potentially firing Powell before his term ends and possibly selecting Warsh to be his successor, the people said.

Warsh has advised against firing Powell and has argued that he should let the Fed chair complete his term without interference, according to the people. The conversations with Warsh carried into Feb-

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◆ **What economists see ahead for growth.....** A4

Countries Across the Globe Are Vowing to Buy American

In the two weeks since President Trump unleashed his sweeping set of reciprocal tariffs, many U.S. trade partners have a clear plan to con-

in a bid to eliminate their trade imbalances with the U.S., while others are urging a collective response to stave off pressure from Washington. Some countries, however, can't, or won't, open their wallets.

Washington is negotiating with more than 70 nations over the sky-high reciprocal tariffs Trump announced on April 2, which Trump termed "Liberation Day." He later paused the levies until July.

Trump said on Thursday he would have "very little problem" making a deal with the

European Union to reduce tariffs in exchange for access to a U.S. market he said has "something everyone wants."

"There will be a trade deal, 100%," Trump said during meetings at the White House with Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni of Italy. She invited Trump to visit Italy and to meet EU officials for trade talks.

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- ◆ **Levies threaten to crimp energy, other exports.....** A5
- ◆ **Tariff blitz yields a few winners.....** A6

Accountants Get Their Dream: Another Movie About Accounting

CPAs are geeked for return of a film that made them look cool; 'It's our John Wick.'

By MARK MAURER

Leigh Olphin got fed up at work recently while trying to learn how to use new AI automation software. So the 37-year-old accountant did what she often does when she returns home from a stressful day: Watch "The Accountant."

Like many other people in her field, Olphin is obsessed with the 2016 film because it bestows ass-kicking qualities on someone in her decidedly nerdy profession. The movie stars Ben Affleck as Christian Wolff, an accountant with autism who uses both

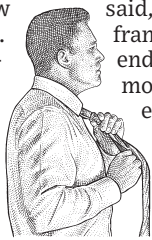
math and martial arts in his job auditing the books for corrupt businessmen.

"It's our 'John Wick,'" she said, referring to the movie franchise centered on a legendary hit man. The Richmond, Va., area resident estimates she has seen "The Accountant" at least 20 times, and it's now part of her Christmas movie rotation even though the movie isn't set during the holidays.

Christmas is coming early this year.

"The Accountant 2" hits theaters next week, 10 days after the tax-filing deadline

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Ben Affleck

A Televangelist Finds Herself At Home in the White House

Paula White, a longtime friend of the president, mixes prayer, politics and raising money for her ministry

By AARON ZITNER

In March, six weeks after President Trump appointed her to lead his White House Faith Office and set her up with an office in the West Wing, evangelical Christian leader Paula White preached in a YouTube sermon that the Passover-to-Easter period provided the faithful with an opportunity to receive "seven supernatural blessings."

"God will assign an angel to you," she said. "He'll be an enemy to your enemies. He'll give you prosperity." Citing a verse from Exodus, she added that God also had decreed that "none shall appear before me empty-handed."

The video then pivoted into fundraising mode, outlining a series of gifts for honoring God and supporting her ministry, culminat-

ing in a Waterford crystal cross for a "Passover/Easter resurrection offering of \$1,000 or more." Next came footage of Trump in the Oval Office lauding White's ministry and political work. "You have helped us so much in so many different ways," Trump said.

Over a four-decade career as a preacher and televangelist, the 58-year-old White has become both enormously influential and controversial in the evangelical world. Her 24-year friendship with Trump, which she said began when he called her after seeing her preach on a Florida TV station, has culminated in a role that combines religion and politics in ways that have little precedent in modern White House history.

In addition to advising the White House office set up to empower faith groups, White

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TOMORROW



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